

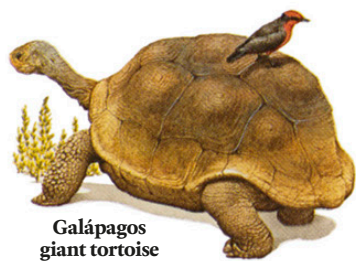


WHAT WE CAN DO TO HELP



Black rhinoceros

- Stop buying goods made from rare animals, such as fur coats, skin bags and shoes, ivory carvings, or shell jewelry.
- Set aside areas of land or water as national parks or wildlife sanctuaries, where animals can live safely with as little disturbance as possible.
- Breed endangered animals in captivity in zoos or wild animal parks. This is especially important in places where it is not possible to save the animals' habitat from being destroyed. Captive-bred animals could be released back into the wild in the future if a suitable home is found.
- Pass laws against hunting rare species.
- Reduce the amount of pollution, so that animals are not killed or harmed by poisonous materials in the environment.
- Take care of the countryside by keeping to paths, taking litter home, and being careful not to disturb wild animals.
- Stop animals, such as parrots, from being taken from the wild and sold as pets.
- Join conservation organizations to protest against the things that threaten the survival of rare animals, raise money for projects, and make other people more aware of the problems.
- Carry out research to find out as much as possible about the natural lives of rare animals so that we can plan the best way to protect them.



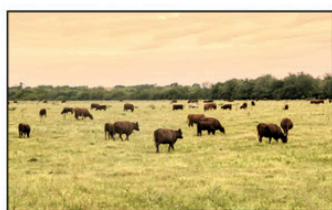
Galápagos giant tortoise

INTRODUCED SPECIES

People take animals from one country to another. Some of these introduced species are not suited to their new home and die out. Others flourish and increase in numbers, upsetting the balance of life among animals already living in the country.

On the Galápagos Islands, for instance, introduced goats compete with the native giant tortoises and land iguanas for food. Flightless birds in New Zealand, such as the kakapo, are endangered because cats, rats, stoats, and ferrets—all of which are introduced species—eat the birds' eggs and young.

Some species are introduced to a country to solve one problem but end up causing much more serious problems. Cane toads were introduced to Australia to eat beetles that were destroying the sugar cane crop. With no natural enemies in Australia, these poisonous toads spread fast, and now threaten the survival of native frogs, reptiles, and small mammals.



Farmers have introduced large herds of grazing animals, such as sheep and cattle, to the grassy pampas plains of South America. Farmers often start fires to encourage the growth of new grass.



Large herds of deer once grazed on the pampas, but their range has shrunk by up to 99 per cent. A conservation program has helped to prevent their extinction.



Osprey

POLLUTION

Many farmers use chemicals on their crops, which can seep into the soil and rivers and may poison wildlife. Poisonous chemicals from factories and sewage works may also be dumped into rivers or the sea. Another form of pollution, acid rain, is caused when the chemicals from vehicle exhausts, power stations, and factories join up with water in the air and fall as rain. Rainwater collects in streams and rivers and flows into lakes, making their waters more acidic and killing the fish that live there. Birds such as ospreys eat the fish and suffer because the poisons become concentrated in their bodies. If they ingest certain pesticides, they may lay eggs with thin shells, and have chicks with deformed bones. Acid rain also destroys forests, particularly conifer trees, reducing the habitats available for animals. Plastic pollution has become a particular concern in recent years. Plastic items are not easily broken down in the environment, and they often end up in the oceans and freshwater habitats, killing many of the seabirds and other marine animals that try to eat them..



Oil sometimes escapes into the sea after a tanker runs aground. Oil sticks birds' feathers together, so they cannot keep out the cold and wet or dive for food.



Many animals that live in the Mediterranean Sea, such as this rare Mediterranean monk seal, have been affected by oil, sewage, and industrial chemical pollution, making it difficult for some species to survive.